

8. PEARLS OF WISDOM

EXERCISE 1- POST READING

Q1. What did the wealthy brother ask the poor brother and what was his reply?

Ans: The wealthy brother asked his poor brother to join the service of Sultan but the poor brother refused his offer sagaciously by saying that he would not compromise his freedom. He was happy with barley bread instead of wearing gold belt and standing in the service of others. Instead of holding his hands before Sultan, he was happy to use those hands in cement and lime. He preferred eating one bread over fully satiating but bending the back in service.

Q2. Why could the slave not be pacified even though, he was in the same boat of the king?

Ans: He was afraid as he had never been to the sea before. He was trembling with fear. He did not know the safety of the boat. When the wise man taught him the lesson, he learnt that boat was quite safe and was utterly pacified. He sat in the corner quite calmly.

Q3. What did the wise man do to make the slave realize about the security of the boat?

Ans: The slave had never been at the sea. He was too much terrified. The king tried his level best but could not be able to pacify him. The wise man threw him in the water. He was very close to death. He learnt that boat is quite safe for him. When he managed to get back in the boat, he was completely pacified and sat calmly in the corner.

Q4. What kind of virtue did the sage want to teach to his students? OR How does professional man earn respect according to the sage?

Ans: The sage taught his students a wonderful lesson. He taught then the value of learning a skill. Acquiring a skill is many times better than wealth and property because these can be robbed and stolen whereas the skill remains with a person throughout his life. This is the reason that a professional man is paid great respect. He is given remarkable value wherever he goes.

Q5. Who is lucky and unlucky according to a maxim?

Ans: A lucky person is the one who enjoys his life. An unlucky person instead of enjoying his life keeps increasing the wealth and property. According to this maxim, property and wealth are for human comfort not to be accumulated. One should use this material for comfort in this life not for accumulation. He who dies without enjoying life is unlucky person.

Q6. Confide not to a friend every secret thou possess. How know you that he will not sometime become thy foe? How far do you agree and why?

Ans: In life man comes across many ups and downs. Anything can happen at any point in time one must not reveal the secret to a close friend even. A friend can turn into enemy. If he knows the secret, he will be very dangerous. I am whole heartedly in agreement to it as it has universal appeal in it. Life has witnessed such cases, so a person must keep his secrets to himself.

Q7. What kind of suggestion did Imam Ghazali give to his people?

Ans: Hazrat Imam Ghazali urged his people to ask for anything they did not know. One should not feel ashamed of it. It is too dangerous if you take medicine without prescription of a doctor and without judging the way, lots of people are going on and you follow them. Allah Almighty has blessed us with reason. We should not feel ashamed of asking others if we do not know certain things.